

Interference tactics: White, move 36

Interference tactics

White to move

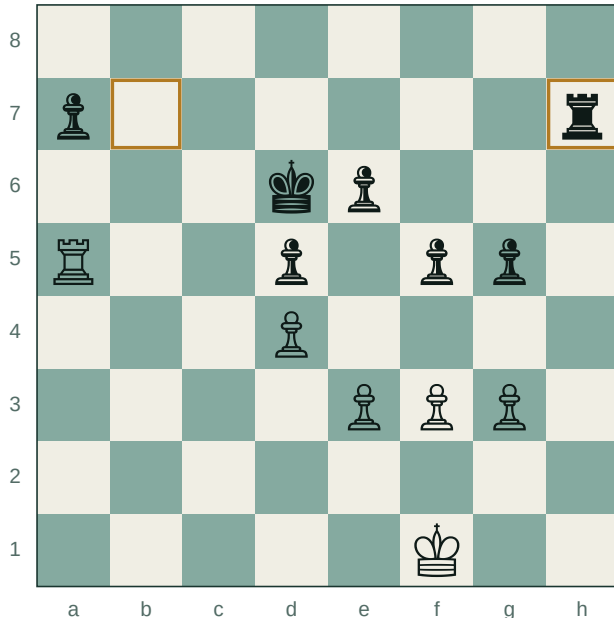
WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Interference interrupts a defensive line between enemy pieces. Occupying one square can make a previously protected target vulnerable or prevent an important recapture.

HOW TO LOOK

Trace the defender's line to its target and inspect forcing moves onto the intervening squares.

The defending king is on d6. Geometrically undefended: rook on h7. Check for tactical protection.



Previous move: 35...Rh7. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

36. Ra6+ Ke7 37. Rxa7+ Kf6 38. Rxh7

36.Ra6+ Check restricts Black to 3 legal replies here. Recorded reply: **36...Ke7**.

37.Rxa7+ Check restricts Black to 5 legal replies here. The move also takes the pawn on a7. Recorded reply: **37...Kf6**.

38.Rxh7 The rook captures the rook on h7.

At the end, nominal material is White 9 / Black 4 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +6. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +6: the balance goes from -1 to +5. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Capturing the interposing piece may restore defense. Calculate which captures are legal and whether they permit another tactic.